

THE COQUITO GUIDE

El ponche navideño · Bilingual holiday drinks

Coconut, cinnamon, rum — the holiday drink that ends every Nochebuena.
Batch it, store it, serve it with confidence.

Mainland-tested · From the Ortiz kitchen

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Coquito — Authentic Puerto Rican Coconut Holiday Drink Recipe

Coquito

Puerto Rico's coconut eggnog — the holiday drink that replaces everything from November through January. Every family has a secret recipe.

Ingredients

- 2 cans (13.5 oz) coconut milk
- 1 can (14 oz) sweetened condensed milk
- 1 can (12 oz) evaporated milk
- 1 cup white rum
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- Pinch of ground nutmeg

Steps

1. Pour all ingredients into a blender: coconut milk, condensed milk, evaporated milk, rum, vanilla, cinnamon, and nutmeg.
2. Blend on high for 1-2 minutes until completely smooth and frothy.
3. Taste and adjust — add more cinnamon for warmth, more rum for kick, or more condensed milk for sweetness.
4. Pour into glass bottles or jars. Refrigerate for at least 4 hours (overnight is better) to let the flavors meld.
5. Serve ice cold over ice, dusted with a generous sprinkle of ground cinnamon on top.

Arroz con Dulce — Puerto Rican Sweet Coconut Rice Pudding Recipe

Arroz Con Dulce

Puerto Rico's sweet coconut rice pudding — the holiday dessert that's actually easy to make.

Ingredients

- 2 cups short-grain rice
- 2 cans (13.5 oz) coconut milk
- 1 can (14 oz) sweetened condensed milk
- 1 cup sugar
- 1/2 cup raisins
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- 1/2 teaspoon ground nutmeg
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

Steps

1. Rinse the rice under cold water until mostly clear.
2. Combine rice, coconut milk, condensed milk, sugar, raisins, cinnamon, and nutmeg in a heavy pot. Bring to a boil, stirring.
3. Reduce heat to low, cover, and cook 25 minutes without stirring.
4. Stir, then cook uncovered 15 more minutes until tender and creamy.
5. Add vanilla. Serve warm or chilled, dusted with cinnamon.

Tembleque — Puerto Rican Coconut Milk Pudding Recipe

Tembleque

A coconut milk pudding that literally jiggles — the holiday dessert on every Puerto Rican Christmas table.

Ingredients

- 2 cans (13.5 oz) coconut milk
- 1/2 cup cornstarch
- 1/2 cup sugar
- 1/4 teaspoon salt
- Ground cinnamon for dusting

Steps

1. In a small bowl, whisk the cornstarch with 1/2 cup of the coconut milk until completely smooth with no lumps. Set aside.
2. Pour the remaining coconut milk into a medium saucepan. Add the sugar and salt. Heat over medium, stirring occasionally, until it reaches a gentle simmer.
3. Whisk the cornstarch mixture one more time, then slowly pour it into the simmering coconut milk, whisking constantly.
4. Continue cooking and whisking for 3-5 minutes until the mixture thickens to a pudding consistency. It should coat the back of a spoon.
5. Pour into a mold, bundt pan, or individual cups. Let cool to room temperature, then cover and refrigerate for at least 4 hours until fully set.
6. To unmold, run a knife around the edges and invert onto a plate. Dust generously with ground cinnamon before serving.